Property Tax Appeal Automation

Feature Status & Strategic Roadmap

Executive Summary

Objective:

Automate the analysis and filing of property tax appeals to reduce tax liability for asset owners.

Current Status:

✅ **Proof of Concept Complete:** Full end-to-end UI and backend logic implemented.
✅ **User Flow:** Seamless wizard guides users from "Analysis" to "Submission".
✅ **Architecture:** Scalable Next.js + Prisma backend ready for production data.

Immediate Decision Point:

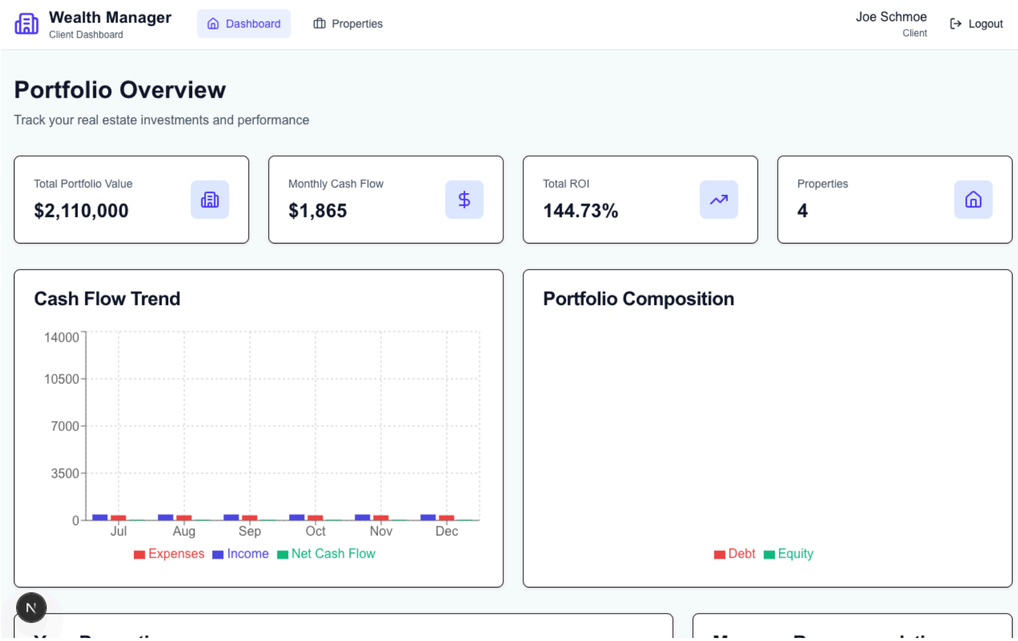
Selecting a data provider for "Comparable Sales" (Comps) to transition from mock data to real-world execution.

1. What We Have Built

The "Tax Savings Engine"

We successfully integrated a tax analysis module into the Asset Dashboard.

- **Smart Detection:** Automatically flags properties that are over-assessed compared to neighbors.
- **Interactive Wizard:** A 3-step process for users to:
    1. Review their assessment.
    2. Select valid comparable properties (evidence).
    3. Generate a draft appeal.



2. Key Value Proposition

Why this matters to our users:

1. **Direct ROI:** Putting money back in the investor's pocket (Top 3 expense for most owners).
2. **High Engagement:** Gives users a reason to log in annually.
3. **Differentiation:** Most asset dashboards track spending; we actively *reduce* it.
4. **Monetization Potential:** Opportunity for a "Success Fee" model (e.g., % of taxes saved).

3. Strategic Decision: Data Integration

The Challenge:

Our current proof-of-concept uses **mock data** for "Comparable Properties." To go live, we need a reliable source of real estate data (Sold History, Tax Assessments, SqFt, etc.).

The Trade-off:

Balancing **Capital Efficiency** (Cost) vs. **Data Quality** (Confidence).

4. Option A: RentCast API (Recommended)

"The Developer-Friendly Choice"

- **Cost:** Free tier (50 calls/mo), then **$74/mo** (scaleable).
- **Pros:**
  - Build specifically for this use case (Rent & Sales comps).
  - Extremely easy integration.
  - Predictable monthly pricing.
- **Cons:** Newer player compared to enterprise giants.

Verdict: 🚀 **Best for Launch.** Low risk, quick to implement.

5. Option B: Estated

"The Pay-As-You-Go Choice"

- **Cost: $0.25 per property look-up**.
- **Pros:**
  - No monthly fixed cost (great if volume is low).
  - Deep property tax data.
- **Cons:**
  - Can get expensive quickly if we scale.
  - "Comps" logic requires multiple calls (1 call for subject + 5 calls for neighbors = $1.50 per analysis).

Verdict: ⚠️ Good for low volume, but hard to predict costs.

6. Option C: Enterprise (Attom / CoreLogic)

"The Bank-Grade Choice"

- **Cost: $500 - $1,000+ per month**, annual contracts.
- **Pros:**
  - Gold standard data quality.
  - Used by major banks and insurers.
- **Cons:**
  - Long sales cycles.
  - Complex integration.
  - High upfront burn.

Verdict: 🛑 **Avoid for now.** Revisit at Series A or >5k users.

7. Proposed Roadmap

Phase 1 (This Week):

Select **RentCast** (Free Tier). Update service to replace mock data with real API calls.

Phase 2 (Next Month):

Beta test with 5-10 users. Validate that the "Savings Opportunities" we identify are real and actionable.

Phase 3 (Post-Funding/Revenue):

Evaluate enterprise contracts if data quality from RentCast proves insufficient.

Discussion & Next Steps

1. **Approval:** Do we have approval to integrate the **RentCast Free Tier**?
2. **Beta Group:** Who are the first 3 partners/investors we should demo this to?